Their command and control structures were dismantled. The only flaw was that Fazlullah and his diehard companions escaped to Afghanistan.

According to confirmed information, he had moved to Kunar province of Afghanistan and carried out cross-border incursions on Pakistani check posts. On 27 August 2011, approximately 200–300 militants launched an attack from Kunar and Nuristan provinces of Afghanistan on seven border posts in Chitral, Pakistan. According to a statement of ISPR, 'At least 25 security forces personnel, 16 Frontier Scouts, four policemen and five levies were killed in this terrorist attack from across the border.' The military sources informed that such attacks are planned and carried out by Fazlullah of Swat and Maulvi Faqir Muhammad of Bajaur.

Since their expulsion from their native areas, these terrorists have organised themselves with the support of local Afghan authorities in the two Afghan provinces of Kunar and Nuristan (*Dawn*, 2011).

Afghan intelligence officials in the province of Nuristan also accused the Afghan central government and NATO forces, in particular, of ignoring insurgents there and in other strategically important areas close to the Pakistani border, for instance, the provinces of Laghman, Kunar and Nangarhar, which pose a significant security threat. As stated by one senior police official in the Nuristan province, 'Nuristan is now Al Qaeda and Taliban central.' 'They attack in hundreds, they have blocked key roads. We need to retake these areas from them' (BBC News, 2011).

On the Eid day of 31 August 2011, the TTP based in Kunar kidnapped 30 young boys of the Mohmand tribe from Bajaur and whisked them away to Kunar. A substantial number of US troops based in Kunar failed to trace TTP activities. The Mohmand tribe had sided with the Pakistan Army in operation against militants in Bajaur, as earlier the TTP had kidnapped its children to make a deal for swapping them with their detainees (Mir, 2011).

People and the government became extremely suspicious of the surreptitious backing to these attacks. The Fazlullah-led TTP elements based in Afghan provinces of Kunar and Nuristan liberally carried out militant activities in the Pakistani areas of Chitral, Dir and Bajaur, but the Afghan government and US/NATO forces did not take any action against them. Some termed it a payback for Pakistan as it was supporting the Haqqani network in North Waziristan. It might also be a pressure tactic to browbeat Pakistan for allegedly harbouring Afghan